

Expense Tracker

A command-line Python application to track daily expenses, categorize them, and view spending totals by category. Data is saved permanently using a JSON file.

Features

- Add a new expense (amount, category, note) — date is recorded automatically
- View all recorded expenses
- View total spending grouped by category (Food, Travel, Bills, Other)
- Update an existing expense
- Delete an expense
- View a monthly report with total spending for a chosen month
- Data persists across runs using a JSON file (`expenses.json`)
- Input validation: amount must be a positive number (invalid entries no longer crash the program)

- Handles corrupted/invalid data files gracefully instead of crashing

Technologies Used

- Python 3
- JSON (for file-based data storage)
- `datetime` module (to auto-record the date of each expense)

How It Works

- Expenses are stored as a list of dictionaries, each containing date, amount, category, and note.
- The "Totals by Category" feature loops through all expenses and adds up amounts per category using a dictionary — a simple but practical use of key-value grouping.

How to Run

1. Make sure Python 3 is installed
2. Download `expense.py`
3. Open a terminal in that folder and run:

```
python expense.py
```

4. Follow the on-screen menu to add, view, or delete expenses, or see category totals

Example Menu

```
1. Add  2. View  3. Totals by Category  4.  
Delete  5. Exit  
Enter choice:
```

Future Improvements

- Switch to SQLite for more robust storage
- Add a simple charts/graph view of spending
- Add a monthly budget limit with warnings when exceeded